



Optical sensors do not track on glass laser sensors have no such issues



One of the most important parts of a keyboard is the palm rest that supports the entire weight of your upper wrist and palms

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feet and this is probably what makes it accurate. Our complaint, if any, was with the tacky mouse wheel that just does not feel as good as the metal units on some of the other Logitech mice. Thankfully, the tilt function is a little more robust, but mouse clicking feels very tacky.

Priced at Rs. 2,995, the V470 seems very expensive. But do note that this price is the MRP and street prices are sure to be lower. A good mouse if you're looking for something usable and functional without extra buttons and such. The fact that this mouse doesn't utilise a USB port like 99 per cent of other wireless mice do is probably a clincher for anyone who uses printers, cameras, cell-phones or other such USB interface devices with his notebook.

Microsoft Comfort Curve Keyboard 2000: Not comfortable enough

The Comfort Curve Keyboard 2000 from Microsoft is a wired USB keyboard aimed at those looking for comfort while typing for many hours a day.

The layout of the keys is such that towards the centre of the alphabet keypad the keys are slightly lower and closer to the user than the keys to the right and left. This when viewed from above gives the impression of a downward directed curve in the entire

layout. The rest of the keys i.e. the numeric keypad, are flat.

Each key in the first row, starting at Esc and ending at Pause Break, has a slight rounded top, making it easy to distinguish between the keys. The rest of the keys have more of a comfortable dip which results in a good flow while typing.

There are a few internet and multimedia keys also present on the keyboard, and these include: Back, Forward, Web/Home, Search, Mail, Play/Pause, Volume Controls (including Mute) and Calculator.

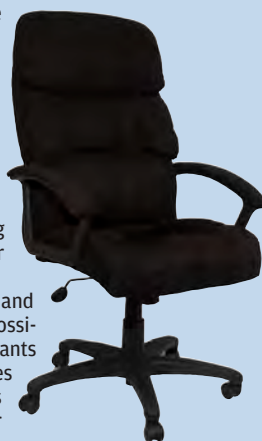
This keyboard does not have standard key sizes as there are long keys towards the centre, giving more accessibility while typing. Another thing we noticed was that the last row of alphabet keys seem to dip downwards. Both these layout features add to the natural and ergonomic experience while typing.



Staples 14548 Fabric Managers Chair Black: Comfy and Elegant

A comfortable chair and one that is almost too comfortable for anyone looking at doing any serious work. After a couple of hours in this beauty we felt as if we could fall asleep in it – high praise indeed for a chair that's meant for executives and managers. Called the Staples Ellston Chair, this beauty is finished in black microsuede and the fabric feels very comfortable and soft to touch. It's a well-padded chair and the padding is firm, so it does not depress with your body weight; this is important so that you do not get that sinking-into-the-chair-feeling. There's lumbar support provided and the chair is well contoured to fit the normal human back. Just near the neck there's a slight protrusion in the foam padding that provides good support to the neck region when seated in a proper upright posture. When seated in such a position we also found that the extra padding around the lower back area provided support to the lower lumbar region and basically reduced stress on the lower back, which is exactly what such chairs are designed to do. On a slight negative note, the armrests are not height adjustable, but they are at a perfect height for most people, so this should not be an issue. The padding on the armrest is also sufficient. Another negative and maybe a serious omission is that while the chair is height adjustable there is no locking mechanism for the back rest. Some chairs we've seen have this very useful feature allowing one to simply lean on the back rest thereby pushing it back and locking it into position – this allows you to recline backward without stressing the muscles of your back by continuously applying pressure on the back rest to keep it from swinging back into position. The fabric used is cool, a blessing for climates such as ours, and even without airconditioning we didn't find ourselves perspiring as much as when seated in some faux leather and real leather chairs.

Priced at Rs. 7,990 (MRP), the 14548 Ellston is expensive and may not be worth its price but it's a really comfortable chair, possibly too comfortable for an executive, but for a manager who wants to really relax after gruelling, productivity inspiring speeches delivered to his team – this may be just the thing. Home users who spend hours in front of their PCs may also want to consider it, since it's priced better than its sibling.



Coming to the Space Bar key, this is the only key we particularly did not like as the feedback is just too mushy. This is expected from most keyboards as the Space bar key is the most used. Other than the space bar, the feedback of the other keys is good.

The Curve does not have a palm rest even though the design matches the design of the general curved layout. But we feel this is a gross ergonomic blunder, as without a correct type of wrist rest you risk Carpal Tunnel Syndrome – a serious problem. Another flaw we noticed was that while typing, you tend to put pressure on the edge, which in turn causes the keyboard to lift up from time to time as it is very light.

Though there has certainly been some thought put into this keyboard to make it ergonomic and comfortable, it has not been executed that well and we wouldn't recommend that you buy this.

Microsoft Wireless Laser Mouse 6000: The Right Choice

The Wireless Laser Mouse 6000 is one of their ergonomic mice. It's not an ambidextrous mouse, as the design favours only right-handed people.

Its a greyish-silver colour on the top surface, and black everywhere else. It feels a little heavy due to the AA batteries powering it. The mouse connects to the PC by RF through a USB dongle which can also be clipped on the back of the mouse.

The mouse curves slightly to the right, with just the right amount of space that results in a scallop for your thumb to fit into. There are also indents present for the rest of the four fingers so that they can comfortably rest on the mouse; this adds to its ergonomic feel. There are two shortcut buttons pres-



ent on the top, towards the left side, which control zooming. The keys are appropriately placed and so you will neither tend to accidentally press them nor are they hard to get to if you use your thumb.

This mouse also has a Windows Flip 3D key which can be used from the scroll button. The scroll wheel also allows for 4-way scroll, in a similar manner to a tilt-wheel.

This mouse is big and is better for desktop use, though it can be used with a notebook, carrying it along might seem a burden.

The only complaint we have is with the scroll wheel, in that it is too smooth and does not have precision scroll. This causes inaccurate scrolling from time to time.

It does not have as many features or buttons as the MX Revolution, but it definitely beats the LX8 in terms of design and comfort. ■

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